**From:** **Marc Weiss** mweiss@weblab.org
**Subject:** 1st of 2 / Pentagon Gives Anthropic an Ultimatum Over the Company's A.I. Model - The New York Times
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# *Pentagon Gives A.I. Company an Ultimatum*

Anthropic insists on limits on how its technology is used and could be labeled a supply chain risk if it fails to accept the military's demands.

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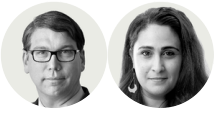
Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth summoned the chief executive of Anthropic to Washington for a meeting on Tuesday. Kenny Holston/The New York Times



**By Julian E. Barnes and Sheera Frenkel**

Julian E. Barnes reported from Washington, and Sheera Frenkel from San Francisco.

Feb. 24, 2026

The Pentagon delivered an ultima
artificial intelligence company cu
military systems, ordering the fir
Friday.

If the firm fails to agree by 5:01 p
Secretary Pete Hegseth said the T
invoke the Defense Production A
model by the military and labelin
risk, according to a senior Pentag
put Anthropic's government cont

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The two threats are fundamentall
the government from using the c
other would force the company t
products.

Despite the contradiction, the thr
in the top ranks of the Pentagon t
its demands and how important t
become to the military.

“The Pentagon knows they are iss
are using every button or lever th
Tillipman, an associate dean at th
University Law School. “The bigg
down these designations. They ar
designed to be national security t
business.”

Mr. Hegseth summoned Dario Ar
executive, to the Pentagon on Tue
The tone of the discussion was civ
agree to Mr. Hegseth’s demands,
it, according to people briefed on

The New York Times spoke to pe
debate over Anthropic’s work wit
on the condition that their names
sensitive negotiations.

Anthropic has argued that it was
assurances that its model would r
Americans or in autonomous wea
operations, that did not involve h

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Anthropic's supporters have cont
being punished for being first on
creating a special model, Claude
same guardrails and restrictions
the public have.

Pentagon officials have said that
lawfully is their responsibility, on
officials say they cannot effectivel
specify how the equipment they s
used, and that lawful use must be

While the Defense Production Ac
ranging powers, it is usually invol
It would be unusual for the act to
company, forcing Anthropic to m
free.

An Anthropic spokesman said tha
good-faith conversations in the m
spokesman said the company wa
government but needed to ensure
line with what they could "reliabl

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But the senior Pentagon official r
said the debate had nothing to do
Pentagon wants all artificial intell
that the military can use the mod

that the military can use the mod

The official confirmed that the Pe
Elon Musk's company xAI to use
model, Grok, on the classified sys

The Pentagon also is close to an a
its Gemini model onto the classifi
official said the deal was not com
product to Grok, regularly yieldin
A person briefed on the meeting s
to demand assurances that its mo
autonomous weapons programs c

Pentagon officials took issue with
reported a conversation that one
a counterpart at the artificial inte
the U.S. military operation last m
Nicolás Maduro of Venezuela.

In the meeting on Tuesday, Mr. A
misunderstanding and that his co
Palantir or the Pentagon about th
according to a person briefed on t

Mr. Amodei insisted his company
interfered with legitimate military

***A correction was made on Feb. 24, 2026**: An earlier version of this article incorrectly described Anthropic's artificial intelligence model Claude Gov. Its guardrails and restrictions are different from those of the company's models available to the public, not from classified models.*

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When we learn of a mistake, we acknowledge it with a correction. If you spot an error, please let us know at corrections@nytimes.com. Learn more

Julian E. Barnes covers the U.S. intelligence agencies and international security matters for The Times. He has written about security issues for more than two decades.

Sheera Frenkel is a reporter based in the San Francisco Bay Area,

covering the ways technology affects everyday lives with a focus on social media companies, including Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram and WhatsApp.

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See more on: Anthropic AI LLC, U.S. Department of Defense, Dario Amodei

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